

**Manufactured goods:**

products made from raw materials using machines, or made by hand.

**Mestizo:** a person of mixed race, with one parent European and the other native Indian.

**Migrant:** a person moving from one place or country to settle in another.

**Mineral:** a natural substance found in rocks of the Earth, such as a metal; removed by mining.

**Missionary:** a person who goes abroad trying to convert others to his or her particular religion.

**Monarchy:** a country ruled by a king or queen who has usually inherited the position rather than been elected by the people.

**Monsoon:** a wind that changes direction with the change of seasons; it causes a rainy season from April to October in Southeast Asia.

**Multicultural:** a group of people or a society made up of various different ethnic groups.

**Native peoples:** the people who belong by birth or origin to a place.

**Natural resources:** materials that occur naturally in an area, such as wood, coal, oil, or gas.

**Nomads:** people who move from place to place in search of food, water, and land to graze their animals.

**Northern hemisphere:** the half of the Earth that lies north of the equator.

**Oasis:** a fertile place in the desert, where water lies near or on the surface.

**Ore:** a mineral or rock from which a valuable metal, such as iron, gold, or copper, can be mined or extracted.

**Overfarming:** exhausting the soil by growing too many crops.

**Overgrazing:** exhausting the land by not moving animals around to graze in different places.

**Overpopulation:** when population growth exceeds economic growth and results in food shortages and lack of housing.

**Paddy field:** a flooded field where rice is grown.

**Peninsula:** a strip of land surrounded on three sides by water.

**Petrochemicals:** chemicals obtained from natural gas or oil.

**Phosphate:** a chemical compound used in fertilizers and detergents.

**Pilgrim:** a person who goes on a journey, or pilgrimage, to a sacred place.

**Plantation:** a large farm using hired workers to grow and harvest one main crop, such as coffee, sugarcane, rubber, or cotton.

**Plateau:** a high, flat area of land.

**Population density:** the number of people living in a given area of land.

**Racism:** the belief that one's own racial group is superior to others.

**Raw materials:** the basic materials, such as minerals or wood, used to make a product.

**Refined oil:** oil that has been treated to remove water and other impurities to separate out fuels such as gasoline and diesel.

**Refugee:** a person who has fled to another country in search of safety because of war, or political or religious oppression.

**Regime:** a particular government, or system of government.

**Republic:** a country ruled by elected representatives of its people, with an elected president rather than a king or queen.

**Reserves:** the amount of a resource, such as copper, known to exist, and not yet used.

**Revolution:** the overthrow of a government.

**Ring of Fire:** the zone around the Pacific Ocean where there are many volcanoes and frequent earthquakes.

**Rural:** relating to the countryside.

**Sahel, the:** zone of semidesert and dry grassland to the south of the Sahara in Africa.

**Sanctions:** penalties imposed by one or more countries on another to persuade that country to follow a certain course of action.

**Savanna:** open grassland in a tropical or subtropical region.

**Shantytown:** an area in or around a city where people live in temporary shacks, often without basic services such as running water.

**Silt:** very small particles deposited by a river or lake.

**Slash-and-burn agriculture:** a method of clearing land to create fields, by cutting down trees or bushes and then burning away any remaining roots.

**Social services:** welfare services provided by a state or local authority.

**Socialism:** a system of society in which goods are owned collectively and the whole community exercises political power.

**Softwood:** wood from cone-bearing trees, such as pine or cedar.

**Soil erosion:** the natural wearing away of the soil by wind or rain.

**Southern hemisphere:** the half of the Earth that lies south of the equator.

**Standard of living:** the quality of life in a country,

usually measured by income, possessions, and levels of health care and education.

**Staple crop or food:** a crop that provides the main food of a region, such as rice, potatoes, or wheat.

**Steppe:** vast grass-covered plains, that stretch from eastern Europe across central Asia.

**Stock exchange:** an international market for buying and selling the stocks or shares of a public company.

**Subsistence farming:** raising just enough crops or animals to feed the farmer's family.

**Technology:** the development of methods, materials, and tools used in doing work.

**Terrorist:** a person who uses violence to win demands or influence the policies of a government.

**Third world:** the poorer, less-developed parts of the world in Asia, Africa, and Central and South America.

**Urban:** relating to a town or city.

**Vegetation:** the plant life of a region.

**Welfare system:** the way a government organizes assistance to its people, particularly the young, the elderly, the sick, and the unemployed.

**West, the:** the Western, industrially advanced countries of the world, specifically North America and western Europe.

**Workforce:** all the people available to work in a country; all the workers employed by a particular factory or place of work.